Figure 6.2 If you use static URL-based mapping, you need a different handler for every product in your product range. With a query string, you can use a single handler, and the query string contains the data. With routing, multiple URLs map to a single handler, and a dynamic parameter captures the difference in the URL.

As well as enabling dynamic URLs, routing fundamentally decouples the URLs in your application from the definition of your handlers.

File-system based routing

In one alternative to routing, the location of a handler on disk dictates the URL you use to invoke it. The downside of this approach is that if you want to change an exposed URL, you also need to change the location of the handler on disk.

This file-based approach may sound like a strange choice, but it has many advantages for some apps, primarily in terms of simplicity. As you'll see in part 2, Razor Pages is partially file-based but also uses routing to get the best of both worlds!

With routing it's easy to modify your exposed URLs without changing any filenames or locations. You can also use routing to create friendlier URLs for users, which can improve discovery and "hackability." All of the following routes could point to the same handler:

- `/rates/view/1`
- `/rates/view/USD`
- `/rates/current-exchange-rate/USD`
- `/current-exchange-rate-for-USD`